
Finance & Mortgage Checklist

Finance falls over on paperwork and surprises, almost never on rates. Get your file lender-ready before you offer and the mortgage becomes the boring part of the deal — which is exactly what it should be.

01 Your file, lender-ready

- ☐ Three months' personal and business bank statements, clean and explainable
 - ☐ Proof of deposit with a paper trail — gifted funds need a signed letter
 - ☐ SA302s / accounts for two years if self-employed
 - ☐ Credit file pulled and read by you first — fix errors before a lender finds them
 - ☐ Existing portfolio schedule: address, value, loan, rent for every property
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02 The deal, lender-ready

- ☐ Rent evidenced by comparables — lenders stress at 125-145% cover, so know your ICR
 - ☐ Property type flagged early: ex-council, above commercial, non-standard construction all narrow the panel
 - ☐ HMO: article 4 status, licence requirement and room sizes confirmed
 - ☐ Refinance plans: lenders want 6 months' ownership before most remortgages — plan the bridge accordingly
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03 Structure questions to settle with your broker

- ☐ Personal name vs limited company — tax treatment differs; take advice, not internet opinion
 - ☐ Interest-only vs repayment against your cash flow target
 - ☐ Fixed term length vs your exit timeline — ERCs punish early refinances
 - ☐ Fee-loaded rate vs higher rate with low fees — total cost over the term, not the headline
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04 Red flags that kill applications

- ☐ Unexplained deposits landing in your account mid-application
 - ☐ New credit taken during the application
 - ☐ Price renegotiated without telling the lender
 - ☐ Works started before completion on a mortgaged purchase
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